

## Philippine History

### The Land and People

- The Philippines is an archipelago compassed of 7,110 islands and islets.
- It belongs to the northern hemisphere and part of the South East Asian region.
- The largest island is Luzon(40,814 sq.miles) followed by Mindanao (36,906 sq. miles), and Samar
- Mt. Apo is the highest peak.
- The mountain ranges are Sierra Madre (longest continuous), Western Caraballo, Caraballo de Baler, Zambales Range, Tagaytay Ridge, and Central Eastern, Central Western and Western mountain range.
- The rivers in Luzon as follows: Cagayan River(longest), Agno River, Abra River and Pampanga River, whereas in Mindanao, Mindanao and Agusan River.
- There are 17 regions, 80 provinces, 122 cities and 1,512 municipalities. The following are the regions: I - Ilocos Region, II – Cagayan Region, III – Central Luzon, IVA- CALABARZON, IVB MIMAROPA, V – Bicol Region, VI – Western Visayas, VII – Central Visayas, VIII – Eastern Visayas, IX – Zamboanga Peninsula, X – Northern Mindanao, XI – Davao Region, XII - SOCCSKSARGEN, XIII - CARAGA, CAR, NCR, and ARMM.
- In 19<sup>th</sup> century Rizal and other Filipinos propagandists used the term **Filipino** to refer to the natives.
- Filipino myth and folklore state that the first Filipinos were Malakas and Maganda.
- Dr. Robert Fox discovered the Tabon Man (22,000 BC) considered as the First Filipino.

### Pre colonial Life and Culture

- The Bahay Kubo (nipa hut) made of bamboo, wood nipa palm, cogon and whatever native materials found in the area.
- The Kalingas and Igorots built their houses on tops.
- The badjaos (sea gypsies) at Sulu lived in boat-houses.
- The male Filipino wore kanggan ( short-sleeved jacket) and bahag (s strip of cloth wrapped around the waist and in between the legs.)
- The Filipino women wore baro or camisa (wide sleeved-jacket and saya patadyong (skirt or lower part.
- The social classes were nobles (gat or lakan), free men and dependent (aliping namamahay and aliping sagigilid)
- Maragtas code- easiest example of the written law.
- The political unit was the barangay which was composed of 30 to 100 families.
- The barangay was a monarchy ruled by a chieftain called Datu, Hari or Raja.

- The chieftain had great powers: chief executive and chief judge with the counsel and adviser from village elders.

#### Timeline of the Philippines

- **25,000 B.C.** Ancient Negroid people immigrate to the Philippines over a land bridge.
- **5,000 B.C. to 3,000 B.C.** The "New Stone Age". **Sea faring Malays** from what is today Indonesia come to the archipelago.
- **3,000 B.C. to 1,000 B.C.** A second wave of Malay immigrants arrives in the Philippines by sea. Each of their ships accommodated one small clan. Such a ship load of people was called a **barangay**, a term which was revived by Marcos to describe an organized neighborhood of more than 1000 people.
- **1200 to 1300.** Migrants from **Borneo** spread into the Southern Philippines.
- **1300 to 1400.** The Hindu empire of **Majapahit** on Java gains influence over parts of the islands.
- **1380.** **Islam** reaches the Southern Philippines via Borneo.
- **1521, Mar 16.** A Spanish expedition, sailing across the Pacific Ocean from east to west, and led by the Portuguese **Ferdinand Magellan** (died Apr 27, 1521) lands on Homonhon Island east of Samar with three small ships, named the Concepcion, Trinidad and Victoria. Magellan calls the place **San Lazaro** Island since March 16 is Saint Lazarus day.
- **1521, Mar 28.** Directing his ships southwestward, Magellan reaches Limasawa Island, south of Leyte. It is ruled by **Rajah Kulambo**, who becomes Magellan's friend.
- **1521, Mar 29.** To seal the friendship between Magellan and Rajah Kulambo, they solemnize a **blood compact**. This is the first recorded blood compact in Philippine history.
- **1521, Mar 31.** The **first mass** on Philippine soil is celebrated on Limasawa.
- **1521, Apr 7.** After sailing to Cebu Island, Magellan enters a new blood compact with the local chieftain, **Rajah Humabon**.
- **1521, Apr 27.** Magellan dies in a battle with **Lapu-Lapu**, chieftain of Mactan, an island near Cebu.
- **1526.** Spain sends a third expedition to the Philippines under the leadership of **Juan Cabot**.
- **1529.** **Saavedra's expedition** returns to Spain without Saavedra who died on the way home.
- **1543, Feb 2.** The leader of the most successful Spanish expedition after Magellan, **Ruy Lopez de Villalobos** (died Apr 4, 1546) arrives in the archipelago. He names the islands the Philippines in honor of the son of King Charles I, Philip II (1556-1598) of Spain. Villalobos reaches Sarangani Island off the eastern coast of Mindanao and settles there for 8 months. But because of the scarcity of food, the expedition is forced to leave the place and sails to the Moluccas where Villalobos dies.
- **1565, Feb 13.** With four ships and 380 men, **Miguel Lopez de Legaspi** arrives in the Philippines.
- **1565, May 8.** The Island of Cebu is surrendered to Legaspi by its ruler **King Tupas**. Legaspi establishes the first permanent Spanish settlement on Cebu and becomes the first Spanish Governor-General. By his order, **tributes** are collected from all Filipino males aged 19 to 60.

- **1568.** The **Portuguese**, under the command of General Gonzalo de Pereira, attack Cebu and blockade its port.
- **1570.** The Portuguese again attack the colony and are repulsed. The series of attacks stems from Portugal's claim to the territory based on the provision of the **Treaty of Tordesillas** entered into by Spain and Portugal on **June 7, 1474**, in which their respective spheres of influence, trade and conquest were defined. The Portuguese believe that the Philippines falls within their sphere.
- **1570, May.** Legaspi sends an expedition under the leadership of Martin de Goiti to Manila. Manila is ruled by **Rajah Suliman**, whose friendship is won by de Goiti.
- **1571, May 19.** Rajah Suliman wages war against the Spaniards due to a move by de Goiti which he mistakes for an assault. De Goiti's army defeats Suliman's troops and **occupies** the town.
- **1571, Jun 24.** Legaspi establishes his government in Manila and proclaims it the **capital** of the Philippines, calling it the "distinguished and ever loyal city".
- **1572, Aug 20.** Legaspi dies and Guido de **Lavezares** (died 1575) succeeds him as governor. Lavezares extends colonization to the Bicol region.
- **1574, Nov 23.** The Chinese pirate captain **Limahong** attacks Manila but the Spaniards win with the help of the Filipinos.
- **1574, Dec 2.** **Limahong** again attacks Manila, this time with 1,500 soldiers, but cannot conquer the city.
- **1574, Dec.** In Tondo (now a district of Manila) **Lakandula** leads a short revolt against the Spanish.
- **1580.** The Spanish King Philip II receives the **throne of Portugal** upon the death of the Portuguese King Sebastian. This puts an end to the Portuguese harassment of the Philippine archipelago.
- **1580.** The Spaniards institute **forced labor** on all male natives aged 16 to 60.
- **1583, Aug.** A great **fire** in Manila which starts from the candles around the bier of governor Penalosa.
- **1589.** The Spaniards establish the first school in the Philippines, the **College of San Ignacio**.
- **1600.** The **Dutch** attack the archipelago in a tactical offensive during the European war between Spain and the Netherlands.
- **1600.** Governor Sebastian Hurtado de Corcuera begins collecting the **bandala** from the natives. Bandala is an annual quota of products assigned to the natives for compulsory sale to the government.
- **1600.** The **Galleon trade** between Manila and Acapulco, Mexico begins. But Manila serves merely as a transshipment port for the exchange of goods between **Spain** and **Mexico** on the one side and **China** on the other. Silver from Mexico is traded for any kind of Chinese merchandise. Because of the Galleon trade's quick returns, Spain lacks interest in developing the Philippine economy during the first 200 years of its occupation.
- **1603.** Chinese insurrection in Manila.

- **1622.** An early revolt takes place in **Bohol**. It is headed by **Tamblot**, a babaylan or priest of the native religion. Revolts in Leyte, Samar and Panay follow, all protesting the collection of tributes.
- **1744.** One of the most successful revolts in Philippine history breaks out, once more in **Bohol**, and provides the island a kind of independence from the Spaniards for the following 85 years. The first leader of the revolt is **Francisco Dagohoy**.
- **1754, May 15.** Mt Taal emits magma and destroys the towns of Lipa, Sala, Tanauan and Talisay.
- **1762, Sep 22.** In a side encounter of the European **Seven Years War**, the British attack Manila with 13 vessels and 6,830 men under the command of General William Draper and Admiral Samuel Corning. The British win the battle and occupy the city.
- **1762, Oct 5.** The British take control of the Philippines and **Darsonne Drake** becomes Governor-General. The British open the colony to international trade and ultimately change its economic life.
- **1762, Dec 14.** A revolt under the leadership of **Diego Silang** (Dec 16, 1730 - May 28, 1763) breaks out in the Ilocos region.
- **1763, May 28.** The revolt ends as Diego Silang is **assassinated** by his former friend Miguel Viscos.
- **1763, Feb 10.** The **Treaty of Paris** between England, Spain and France is signed, ending the Seven Years War in Europe as well as the British occupation of the Philippines.
- **1774, Nov 9.** Parishes are **secularized** by order of King Charles III of Spain. Natives are also permitted to enter the Catholic priesthood.
- **1808, May.** French Emperor Napoleon Bonaparte installs his brother **Joseph** as King of Spain. French-influenced liberals support the king but the people do not.
- **1809, Jan 22.** As an effect of the appointment of Joseph Bonaparte as King of Spain, all Spanish colonies including the Philippines are made **integral parts of Spain** by the Spanish Central Junta. Filipinos are given the privileges of Spanish citizenship as well as representation in the Spanish Cortes (parliament).
- **1812 Mar 19.** The Spanish Cortes promulgates the **Cadiz Constitution**. It is a liberal constitution, vesting sovereignty in the people, recognizing the equality of all men and the individual liberty of the citizen, and granting the right of suffrage, but providing for a hereditary monarchy and for Catholicism as the state religion.
- **1812, Sep 24.** The first **Philippine delegates** to the Spanish Cortes, Pedro Perez de Tagle and Jose Manuel Coretto take their oath of office in Madrid, Spain.
- **1813 Mar 17.** Spain officially implements the Cadiz Constitution in Manila.
- **1813, Oct 16 to 19.** The **Battle of the Nations** near Leipzig, Germany; it ends with Napoleon and the French defeated.
- **1813, Oct.** Following the French defeat at Leipzig, the British General Duke of Wellington drives the Napoleonic forces **out of Spain**.
- **1814.** Ferdinand VII, son of Charles IV, is recognized as **King of Spain**.

- **1815, Jun 18.** Napoleon Bonaparte is defeated in a battle with another multi-national army under Wellington at **Waterloo**, Belgium.
- **1815, Oct 15.** Bonaparte is exiled to **St. Helena's Island** in the Atlantic Ocean, off the coast of West Africa.
- **1816, May 24.** After the defeat of Napoleon in Europe and his brother's loss of the Spanish throne, **conservative forces** again dominate Spanish politics. The Spanish Cortes rejects the Cadiz Constitution which means, among other things, that Philippine representation in the Cortes is abolished.
- **1820.** Changes in Philippine economic life, partially introduced by the British, lead to some internal **prosperity**. In agriculture, crops are relegated by region so that **tobacco** becomes the chief crop of the north, **sugar** the main crop of the Visayas, and **abaca** the mainstay of the Bicol region. The same year, foreigners are massacred in Binondo. They were under suspicion of poisoning Pasig river and thus being responsible for a severe epidemic of cholera.
- **1828.** An **earthquake** lasting between 2 to 3 minutes damage a number of buildings and churches in Manila.
- **1830.** The Port of Manila is opened to the world market.
- **1835.** The **Chamber of Commerce** is installed. Francisco Rodriguez establishes the first Filipino bank.
- **1848.** Glowing avalanche from Mt Hibok-Hibok on Camiguin island
- **1852, Dec 4 to 6.** Glowing avalanche from Mt Hibok-Hibok.
- **1863.** The **educational system** in the archipelago is reformed, allowing the natives higher levels of training. Wealthier native families start sending their children to study in Spain.
- **1863, Jun 3.** At 19:00, a terrific **earthquake** shakes Manila and ruins most buildings in the city, including the cathedral. Of major structures, only the **San Agustin** church remains standing.
- **1869, Nov 17.** The **Suez Canal** is opened, establishing a regular steamship service between the Philippines and Europe. This allows not only the influx of more goods into the colony but also of new ideas.
- **1872, Feb 17.** Three **martyr priests** are publicly garroted as alleged leaders of the **Cavite Conspiracy**, a movement for secularization and nationalism, which is distasteful to the Spanish friars. They are **Jose Burgos** (born Feb 9, 1837), **Mariano Gomez** (born Aug 2, 1799) and **Jacinto Zamora** (born Aug 14, 1835). The incident gives the Filipinos an impetus to unite and to develop national consciousness. It also gives birth to a reform movement among Filipinos in Spain, known as the **Propaganda Movement**.
- **1880.** Manila is connected through telegraphic cable to the **Western world** by **Eastern Telecom**.
- **1880, Jul 18 & 20.** Two shocks of an **earthquake** create destruction from Manila to Santa Cruz, Laguna. Tremors continue until Aug 6.
- **1882, Mar 3.** A talented offspring of the native elite, **Jose Protacio Rizal Mercado y Alonso Realonda** (Jun 19, 1861 - Dec 30, 1896) leaves Manila for Barcelona to continue his studies in medicine.

- **1882, Jun 2.** In Madrid, Rizal begins writing **Noli me tangere**, a political novel set in the Philippines.
- **1884.** Exaction of tribute from all male natives is ended and the required forced labor of 40 days a year is reduced to 15 days.
- **1884, Jun 21.** Rizal finishes his medical studies in Spain.
- **1887, May 29.** **Noli me tangere** is published in Madrid and Barcelona.
- **1887, Oct.** Rizal begins writing the novel **El Filibusterismo**, a continuation of **Noli me tangere**.
- **1888, Dec 13.** Filipinos in Barcelona establish the organization **La Solidaridad**. It demands for the Philippines freedom of press, speech and assembly, equality before the law, participation in governmental affairs, social and political freedom and representation in the Spanish Cortes. The demands are published and circulated in Barcelona for the purpose of reaching the Spanish King's ear. Among the members are: Jose Rizal, Lopez Jaena (Dec 18, 1856 - Jan 20, 1897), Marcelo del Pilar (Aug 30, 1850 - Dec 3, 1920), Antonio Luna (Oct 29, 1866 - Jun 5, 1899) and Mariano Ponce (Mar 23, 1863 - May 23, 1918).
- **1891, Mar 28.** Rizal finishes writing **El Filibusterismo** in Biarritz, France.
- **1892, Jun 26.** Rizal arrives in the Philippines via Hong Kong.
- **1892, Jul 3.** In Ilaya St, Tondo, Rizal founds **La Liga Filipina** to give the people a chance for direct involvement in the reform movement. **Andres Bonifacio** (Nov 30, 1863 - May 10, 1897) is one of Rizal's partners.
- **1892, Jul 7.** The Spanish authorities **arrest** Rizal for organizing La Liga Filipina.
- **1892, Jul 17.** Rizal is exiled to Dapitan, Mindanao.
- **1894, Jul 8.** Andres Bonifacio forms the **Katipunan**. Its members come from the lower and the middle class. The organization wants to awaken nationalism and free the Filipino people from Spanish oppression and friar despotism. The organization believes that reforms can only be obtained by means of a revolution.
- **1896, Jul 1.** Rizal receives a telegram from Governor Ramon Blanco requiring his services as a physician for the Spanish army in **Cuba**.
- **1896, Aug 6.** Rizal returns to Manila.
- **1896, Aug 19.** Spanish authorities discover the Katipunan when one of its members, Teodoro Paterno, betrays the organization to an Agustinian priest, Fr. Mariano Gil. All those implicated are ordered arrested but many Katipuneros evade arrest and **flee** to the hills of Balintawak.
- **1896, Aug 23.** A revolution is proclaimed by Bonifacio. The event is marked in history as the **Cry of Balintawak**. In this instance, Filipinos tear up their cedula (I.D. cards) issued by the Spanish government and thereby mark the beginning of the uprising against the Spaniards.
- **1896, Aug 26.** Rizal goes to Cavite where he boards a ship for Barcelona. In the following night, Andres Bonifacio, Emilio Jacinto and other Katipuneros are able to surreptitiously board Rizal's ship. They offer to rescue him from the Spaniards, but **Rizal refuses**.

- **1896, Aug 30.** After the spread of the Katipunan revolt throughout The Country the first real battle for Philippine independence takes place at **San Juan del Monte**. The Spanish Governor Ramon Blanco proclaims a **state of war** in the 8 provinces that took up arms. The provinces are Manila, Laguna, Cavite, Batangas, Pampanga, Bulacan, Tarlac and Nueva Ecija.
- **1896, Sep 2.** Aboard the ship **Isla de Panay**, Rizal leaves Cavite for Barcelona.
- **1896, Oct 3.** Rizal arrives in Barcelona.
- **1896, Oct 4.** By order of Capt. Gen. Despujol, Rizal is incarcerated in Montjuich.
- **1896, Oct 6.** On orders from Madrid, Rizal is sent back to Manila as a **prisoner**.
- **1896, Oct 31.** A new group of the Katipunan is formed in Cavite; it discards the leadership of Andres Bonifacio and is headed by **Emilio Aguinaldo** (Mar 22, 1869 - Feb 6, 1964).
- **1896, Nov 13.** Rizal arrives in Manila and is immediately **imprisoned** at Fort Santiago.
- **1896, Nov 20.** Rizal is interrogated the first time on charges of partaking in an uprising against the Spanish government.
- **1896, Dec 20.** Rizal is **sentenced to death** by a Spanish court martial, and Governor Camilo Polavieja orders his execution.
- **1896, Dec 30.** The Spaniards **execute** Jose Rizal in
- **Bagumbayan** (today's Rizal Park).
- **1897, Mar 22.** The Katipunan holds its **election**. Aguinaldo is elected as president while Bonifacio is elected only as director of war. Bonifacio is insulted by the election results and refuses to recognize the new leadership.
- **1897, Apr 29.** Katipuneros arrest Andres Bonifacio and his brothers Procopio and Ciriaco on orders of Aguinaldo, who considers the former a threat. The Bonifacios are charged with **sedition** and **treason** before a military court of the Katipunan.
- **1897, May 8.** The Katipunan court finds the Bonifacios guilty. They are **sentenced to death**.
- **1897, May 10.** Andres Bonifacio and his brothers are **executed** at Mt. Buntis, Maragondon, Cavite.
- **1897, May 31.** Aguinaldo establishes a Philippine republican government in **Biak-na-Bato**, San Miguel, Bulacan.
- **1897, Aug 10.** Aguinaldo begins negotiating with the Spaniards, represented by Pedro Paterno.
- **1897, Aug 15.** An **earthquake** at estimated intensity of 7.9 centered on Luzon's northwest coast shakes Batanes and northern Luzon.
- **1897, Nov 1.** The **Constitution of Biak-na-Bato** is signed. It was prepared and written by Isabelo Artache and Felix Ferrer. The government of the Biak-na-Bato Republic has the following officers: **Emilio Aguinaldo, President**; Mariano Trias, Vice President; Isabelo Artache, Secretary of Interior; Antonio Montenegro, Secretary of Foreign Affairs; Baldomero Aguinaldo, Secretary of Treasury and Emiliano Riego de Jesus, Secretary of War. The Biak-na-Bato Republic fails as its

leader, Aguinaldo, resigns to the fact that the Filipinos are not yet ready to confront the Spanish forces. This belief also drives him to negotiate with the Spaniards for the Pact of Biak-na-Bato.

- **1897, Dec 14.** The **Pact of Biak-na-Bato** between the Spanish and Aguinaldo is signed. In this pact, Aguinaldo agrees to surrender all arms and to go with his companions into exile in Hong Kong upon payment of 800,000 pesos and an additional 900,000 pesos for the non-combatants who suffered losses because of the war.
- **1897, Dec 27.** Aguinaldo and his companions leave for Hong Kong where they live on the **interest** from their money.
- **1898, Feb 8.** The Katipunan is revived by **Emilio Jacinto** (Dec 15, 1875 - Apr 16, 1899) and Feliciano Jocson.
- **1898, Apr 24.** The US government asks Aguinaldo for **cooperation** in its anti-Spanish politics, and offers in exchange the promise of **US support** for the Filipinos in their struggle for independence. Aguinaldo agrees.
- **1898, Apr 26.** The US declares war on Spain.
- **1898, May 1.** The US Navy, with heavily armed ships under the command of **Commodore George Dewey**, attack Manila.
- **1898, May 19.** Aguinaldo and his companions return to the Philippines.
- **1898, May 24.** Aguinaldo proclaims a **dictatorial government** and issues two decrees which show his trust and reliance in US protection.
- **1898, Jun 12.** The Philippines is proclaimed **independent** from Spain in Kawit, Cavite. For the first time, the Philippine flag is officially raised and the Philippine National Anthem is publicly played. The proclamation places the US in the special position of protector of Philippine independence.
- **1898, Jun 23.** Through the advice of Apolinario Mabini (Jul 23, 1864 - May 13, 1903), a paralytic but nevertheless the "brains of the Katipunan", the Philippine dictatorial government is changed to a revolutionary government, and in Malolos, Bulacan the **Malolos Republic** is institutionalized. The Malolos republican government is geared to fight for Philippine independence until it is recognized by the free nations of the world.
- **1898, Jul 15.** Aguinaldo appoints a **cabinet** with the following secretaries: Baldomero Aguinaldo, Secretary of War and Public Works; Leandro Ibarra, Secretary of Interior; Mariano Trias, Secretary of Finance.
- **1898, Jul 15.** Aguinaldo greets the **Malolos Congress** with 136 members. 60 of them are appointed by Aguinaldo while the rest are chosen by representatives of the provinces.
- **1898, Jul 17.** US reinforcements and troops arrive in the Philippines. They number 740 officers and 10,964 men and are commanded by **General Wesley E. Meritt** (died 1910). US treatment of Filipinos changes, as the US no longer needs the assistance of the natives in their war with Spain.
- **1898, Aug 14.** The Spanish in Manila surrender to the US after a pre-arranged **mock battle**. A US military government is established by General Meritt.
- **1898, Sep 15.** The **Malolos Congress** meets and elects its officers. They are: Pedro Paterno (Feb 27, 1858 - Mar 11, 1911), President; Benito Legarda, Vice President; Gregorio Araneta and Pablo Ocampo (Jan 25, 1850 - Feb 5, 1925), Secretaries.

- **1898, Dec 10.** In the **Treaty of Paris** between the US and Spain, the latter sells the Philippines to the US for 20 million dollars.
- **1898, Dec 21.** US President McKinley issues the **Benevolent Assimilation Proclamation** to extend the sovereignty of the US over the entire Philippines, even by force, if necessary.
- **1899, Jan 20.** In the US, President McKinley appoints the **First Philippine Commission**, known as the Schurman Commission, composed of Jacob Schurman, George Dewey, Elwell Otis, Dean Worcester and Wesley Meritt.
- **1899, Jan 21.** The **Malolos Constitution** is promulgated by Aguinaldo. It provides for a republican form of government with the legislature as the supreme branch. The constitution is designed after the constitutions of France, Belgium, and several South American Republics. It was drafted by Felipe Calderon (Apr 4, 1868 - Jul 6, 1908).
- **1899, Jan 23.** The Malolos republic government is **inaugurated**. Aguinaldo takes his oath of office as President.
- **1899, Feb 4.** Hostilities break out between the Filipinos and the US.
- **1899, Feb 6.** The US Senate ratifies the **Treaty of Paris** with Spain and gives the US military a free hand to subdue the Philippines.
- **1899, Mar 4.** The Schurman Commission arrives in Manila. It proclaims the **supremacy of the US** over the entire archipelago, but promises full autonomy.
- **1899, May 6.** Aguinaldo appoints a new cabinet which gives the US government confidence in securing a **peaceful agreement** with the Filipinos. Among the members are: Pedro A. Paterno, Premier; Felipe Buencamino, Secretary of Foreign Affairs; Severino delas Alas, Secretary of Interior; Mariano Trias, Secretary of War; Hugo Ilagan, Secretary of Finance; Aguedo Velarde, Secretary of Public Instruction; Maximo Paterno, Secretary of Public Works and Communications; Leon Ma. Guerrero, Secretary of Agriculture, Industry and Commerce.
- **1899, May 20.** Aguinaldo's moves face opposition from Apolinario Mabini and Antonio Luna. Antonio Luna, (Oct 29, 1866 - Jun 5, 1899) is the ablest Filipino general.
- **1899, Jun 5.** Antonio Luna dies, shot by members of the Kawit Company, composed of Aguinaldo's men.
- **1899, Oct 12.** The US mounts a full scale **offensive** against the Filipinos. Aguinaldo goes into hiding.
- **1900, Jan 31.** The Schurman Commission returns to the US.
- **1900, Mar 16.** US President McKinley appoints the second Philippine Commission, known as the **Taft Commission**. It is composed of Judge William Taft as president, Luke Wright, Henry Ide, Bernard Morris and Dean Worcester.
- **1900, Jun 3.** The Taft Commission arrives in Manila.
- **1900, Dec 23.** A Filipino organization, the **Partido Liberal**, is established with the aim of having the Philippines join the United States.

- **1901, Mar 2.** The Army Appropriation Act, also known as the **Spooner Amendment**, is passed by the US Senate. It provides that the US President governs the Philippines by the authority of Congress and not as Commander-in-Chief of the Armed Forces, thereby formally ending the US military regime in the archipelago.
- **1901, Mar 23.** Aguinaldo is captured by US authorities.
- **1901, Apr 1.** Aguinaldo takes an **oath of allegiance** to the US.
- **1901, Apr 19.** Aguinaldo issues a proclamation of his belief that freedom can be obtained through the **magnanimity** of the US.
- **1901, Jul 4.** A civil government is established in the Philippines, with **William Howard Taft** (Sep 15, 1857 - Mar 8, 1930) as the first US Governor-General.
- **1901, Jul 18.** The US organizes the **Philippine Constabulary**, a native adjunct of the occupation army.
- **1901, Aug 11.** 74 Cuba war veterans are sent to **Balangiga**, at the south end of Samar, under the command of Captain Thomas Connel, presumably to protect the natives from the insurgents and Moro pirates.
- **1901, Sep.** The first Filipino members of the second **Philippine Commission** are appointed, namely: Trinidad Pardo de Tavera, Benito Legarda and Jose Luzurriaga.
- **1901, Sep 27.** Guerillas, headed by the Filipino **Captain Daza**, attack the US military barracks in Balangiga, Samar, by surprise, killing almost half of the US soldiers.
- **1901, Sep 28.** Brigadier Gen. Smith, Commander of Samar, after being informed of the massacre of the soldiers, organizes a special unit of **300 Marines** to be sent to Balangiga under the command of Captain Littleton Wallen.
- **1901, Oct 23.** The special unit of Marines arrives in **Balangiga**. They immediately execute the orders of Brig. Gen. Smith to suppress insurrection. Among the orders is to kill all natives over 10 years old which are capable of carrying weapons.
- **1901, Nov 4.** The Philippine Commission enacts the **Sedition Law** which imposes the death penalty or long imprisonment on anyone who advocates independence or separation from the US.
- **1901, Dec 14.** An earthquake estimated of magnitude 7.8 shakes Lucena City.
- **1901.** Various resistance groups under different leaders are organized in the entire country.
- **1902, Jan.** The first labor union of The Country , **Union de Litografos Impresores de Filipinas**, is organized. The Union del Trabajo de Filipinas, and the Congreso Obrero de Filipinas follow.
- **1902.** The **Cooper Act**, otherwise known as the Philippine Bill of 1902, is passed by a US Senate committee, establishing the **Philippine Assembly** as the lower chamber of a bicameral legislature. The **Philippine Commission** makes up the upper house. The Cooper Act also provides for a bill of rights.
- **1902, Mar 30.** The US Marines leave Balangiga. During their 5 month stay in the region the Marines are on record to have killed **ten thousand natives** in revenge for the earlier surprise

attack by the Filipinos. The US Army also conducted armed missions in Candaba and Macabebe in central Luzon.

- **1903.** Governor Taft enunciates the policy of **The Philippines for the Filipinos**. This policy promises to put the administration of the Philippines into the hands of Filipinos.
- **1904, Feb 1.** Governor-General Taft is succeeded by **Luke Wright**. Taft will serve as the 27th US President from 1909 to 1913.
- **1906, Apr 2.** Governor-General Wright is replaced by **Henry Ide**.
- **1906, Sep 20.** **James Smith** takes over the position of Governor-General Henry Ide.
- **1907, Jun 30.** The first **congressional election** is held. There are 80 new assemblymen elected by 14.1% of the 104,966 registered voters. 59 are Nacionalistas, 16 are Progresistas and the rest come from smaller parties.
- **1909, Nov 11.** Governor-General Smith steps down. **Cameron Forbes** becomes Governor-General.
- **1911, Jan 27.** Mt Taal erupts, devastating Volcano Island and killing 1,334 persons
- **1913, Oct 6.** Governor General Forbes is replaced by **Francis Burton Harrison**.
- **1916, Oct 16.** The **Jones Law**, sponsored by US Congressman William Atkinson Jones, is enacted. It promises independence upon the establishment of a stable government.
- **1916, Oct 16.** **Manuel Quezon** (Aug 19, 1898 - Aug 1, 1941) is elected President of the Senate and **Sergio Osmena** (Sep 9, 1898 - Oct 19, 1961) Speaker of the House of Representatives. There are 24 members of the Senate, 22 of whom are elected by districts while 2 are appointed.
- **1917, Jan 11.** The first **cabinet of Filipinos** under the US regime is organized. It is composed of Rafael Palma (Oct 24, 1874 - May 24, 1939), Secretary of Interior; Alberto Barreto, (Oct 21, 1867 - Dec 7, 1951) Secretary of Finance; Dionisio Jakosalem, Secretary of Commerce and Communication; Victorino Mapa, Secretary of Justice; Galicano Apacible (Jun 25, 1864 - Mar 22, 1949), Secretary of Agriculture and Natural Resources; and Charles Yeaster, Secretary of Information.
- **1921, Oct 5.** Governor-General Harrison is replaced by **Warren Woods**.
- **1925.** Rural and urban **strikes** begin among the discontented peasants and workers of the agricultural and industrial sectors. They continue until 1939.
- **1927.** **Henry Stimson** becomes the new Governor-General of the Philippines.
- **1930, Nov 30.** The **Communist Party of the Philippines** is formally established under the leadership of Crisanto Evangelista and Jacinto Manahan.
- **1932.** Governor-General Stimson is replaced by **Theodore Roosevelt, Jr.**
- **1932, Oct 26.** The Communist Party of the Philippines is declared **illegal** by the Supreme Court.
- **1933, Jun 15.** The last US Governor-General of the Philippines, **Frank Murphy**, begins his term of office.

- **1934, Mar 24.** The Tydings-McDuffie Law, known as the **Philippine Independence Law**, is approved by US President Roosevelt. It provides for a ten year transition period of the Commonwealth of the Philippines under a constitution to be drafted by a Constitutional Convention, the members of which are to be elected by the people.
- **1934, Jul 10.** Election by the Filipino people of the 202 delegates to the **Constitutional Convention** is held in fulfillment of the Tydings-McDuffie Law.
- **1934, Jul 30.** The Philippine **Constitutional Convention** is inaugurated. The officers are: Claro M. Recto (Feb 8, 1890 - Oct 2, 1960), President; Ruperto Manansala and Teodorico Sandico, Vice Presidents; Narciso Pimentel, Secretary; and Jose Diokno, Sergeant-at-arms.
- **1935, Feb 8.** Members of the Constitutional Convention approve the Constitution by a vote of 177 to 1.
- **1935, Feb 8.** Members of the Constitutional Convention approve the Constitution by a vote of 177 to 1.
- **1935, Feb 15.** The Philippine Constitution is signed.
- **1935, Mar 23.** US President Franklin Roosevelt approves the Constitution.
- **1935, May 14.** The Philippine electorate ratifies the Constitution in a referendum.
- **1935, Sep 17.** The Philippines holds its first presidential election. **Manuel Quezon** is elected President, and **Sergio Osmena** Vice-President for a term of 6 years. The other presidential and vice-presidential candidates were Emilio Aguinaldo and Raymundo Milleza; Gregorio Aglipay and Norberto Nabong; and Pascual Racuyal.
- **1935, Nov 15.** The Philippine Commonwealth is **inaugurated** with Manuel Quezon as the first President and Sergio Osmena as the first Vice-President. At this juncture, the office of the US Governor-General is **abolished**.
- **1935.** Strikes and protests, which reject the Constitution and favor the establishment of a **Soviet form of government**, accelerate until 1940.
- **1941, Nov 11.** The Philippines holds its 2nd presidential election under the Commonwealth government. **Quezon** and **Osmena** are re-elected. Other presidential candidates were: Juan Sumulong, Pedro Abad Santos and Hilario Moncado.
- **1941, Dec 8.** Immediately after the bombing of Pearl Harbor, Japanese fighter planes attack the Philippines as an ally of the US, shocking the unprepared US and Filipino troops. **Douglas MacArthur**, the Commander of the US Armed Forces in the Far East, decides to retreat to the Bataan peninsula.
- **1941, Dec 20.** President Quezon, his family and the war cabinet move to **Corregidor Island**.
- **1941, Dec 26.** US troops leave the capital. General MacArthur declares Manila an **open city**, virtually surrendering it to the Japanese.
- **1941, Dec 28.** Filipino and US armies retreat to **Bataan**.
- **1941, Dec 30.** President Quezon and Vice-President Osmena take their oath of office inside the **Corregidor Tunnel**.

- **1942, Jan 2.** Japanese forces enter Manila.
- **1942, Jan 3.** The Japanese Commander in Chief, General **Masaharu Homma**, proclaims the end to US occupation of the Philippines. He declares that the Japanese Imperial forces came to the Philippines to emancipate the Filipinos from the oppressive domination of the US and to promote the well-being of the people under their military administration. He also imposes martial law.
- **1942, Jan 13.** A law is enacted providing for the **death penalty** for acts ranging from sedition to rumor mongering, from destruction of military property to pollution of drinking water, from robbery and looting to concealing clothing to avoid confiscation by the military.
- **1942, Jan 23.** An executive committee, composed of Filipinos, is formed as a conduit of the military administration's policies and requirements. **Jorge Vargas**, the mayor of Greater Manila, is appointed chairman and assigns his colleagues to various departments, e.g. Benigno S. Aquino Sr, Interior; Jose P. Laurel (Mar 9, 1891 - Nov 6, 1959), Justice; Antonio delas Alas, Finance; Rafael Alunan (Dec 16, 1885 - May 18, 1947), Agriculture and Commerce; Claro M. Recto, Education, Health and Public Welfare; Quintin Paredes, Public Works and Communications.
- **1942, Feb 17.** The Japanese issue an order adopting the **Japanese educational system** in The Country , eradicating the one established before by the US and the Spanish. The new educational system deals with the propagation of Filipino culture, the teaching of Nipongo, diffusion of vocational and elementary education, and promotion of love for labor.
- **1942, Feb 20.** President Quezon and the war cabinet leave for the States.
- **1942, Mar 11.** General MacArthur leaves for Australia to take command of the South Western Pacific Area.
- **1942, Mar 13.** The Commonwealth government is moved to the US.
- **1942, Mar 29.** The People's **Anti-Japanese Army** or Hukbong Bayan Laban sa Hapon (Hukbalahap) is organized. Luis Taruc is its chairman. It is composed of peasants and workers from various provinces of central Luzon like Pampanga, Bulacan and Nueva Ecija. Its goal is independence. It is also the only guerilla unit that will not accept directives from **MacArthur** on the conduct of resistance. In the view of MacArthur, the Hukbalahap is a semi-political, semi-bandit organization which plans to establish a communist government in the Philippines.
- **1942, Apr.** A **pro-US resistance movement** is organized, mainly to provide data to the US on enemy positions. The most important organizers are: Marcelo Adurru, Roque Ablan (Aug 9, 1906 - Jan 31, 1943), Alejo Santos, Lorenzo Tanada, Wenceslao Vinzon (Sep 28, 1910 - 1942), Macario Peralta, Tomas Confessor and Wendell Fertig.
- **1942, Apr 9.** Bataan, under US commander General Edward King, is the last province that surrenders to the Japanese armies. The infamous **Death March** follows, the painful trek of 36,000 US and Filipino soldiers and guerillas without food and water. Prisoners of war are bayoneted or brutally beaten to death by their guards. Those who reach San Fernando, Pampanga, are taken to a concentration camp at Capaz, Tarlac.
- **1942, May 6.** **Corregidor** surrenders to the Japanese and 12,000 Filipino and US soldiers are taken prisoners of war.
- **1942, Jun 14.** The Commonwealth of the Philippines becomes a member of the **United Nations**.
- **1942, Dec 30.** The **Kalibapi** is organized. It is an organization sponsored by the Japanese which functions as an instrument for control and indoctrination. It dissolves the existing political parties

and civic organizations. **Benigno Aquino, Sr.** is designated Director-General of the Kalibapi. There is also the Junior Kalibapi, taking in young Filipinos between the ages of 7 and 18.

- **1943, Jun 20.** Japanese Premier Hideki Tojo nominates an all Filipino 20 member **Preparatory Commission** for Philippine Independence.
- **1943, Sep 4.** The Commission drafts a new **Constitution** which provides for a unicameral national assembly.
- **1943, Sep 20.** The 108 delegates to the **National Assembly** are chosen by the members of the Preparatory Commission for Philippine Independence.
- **1943, Sep 15.** The members of the National Assembly elect Jose P. Laurel as the **President** of the Philippines.
- **1943, Oct 14.** The puppet government is inaugurated. Laurel takes his oath of office and asks the US to recognize the "**independence**" of the Philippines.
- **1943, Nov.** The Philippine economy collapses, the shortage of rice becomes serious.
- **1944, May.** The puppet government inaugurates the **Green Revolution Movement**. It requires everyone aged 16 to 60 to plant on all available land to counter the threat of starvation.
- **1944, Aug 1.** **Sergio Osmena** succeeds in the presidency because of Manuel Quezon's death at Saranak Lake due to tuberculosis.
- **1944, Sep 21.** The US raid Manila. The supply of food to the inhabitants worsens. This move by the US prompts the Japanese to press Laurel to **declare war** against the US.
- **1944, Oct 20.** General MacArthur lands in **Palo, Leyte**, accompanied by President Sergio Osmena and US troops.
- **1944, Oct 23.** The Commonwealth government of the Philippines is re-established in **Tacloban, Leyte** which is declared the temporary capital of the Philippines pending liberation of the whole country.
- **1944, Dec 8.** The pro-Japanese Philippine generals Pio Duran and Benigno Ramos organize the **Makapilis**. This is a Philippine army which fights for the Japanese in a number of encounters.
- **1945, Feb 4.** US troops enter Manila and the Japanese, in an **orgy of blood**, massacre thousands of Filipinos.
- **1945, Feb 22.** Luis Taruc, Cato Alejandrino and other Huk leaders are arrested by the US Counter Intelligence Corps and jailed in San Fernando, Pampanga for being communists.
- **1945, Feb 24.** The Battle of Manila ends. The Japanese surrender to the US.
- **1945, Feb 27.** MacArthur hands over Malacanang Palace to Osmena.
- **1945, Mar 22.** The families of pro-Japanese President **Laurel** and Speaker **Aquino** leave The Country for Japan to seek refuge.
- **1945, Jun 5.** The Congress elected in 1941 convenes for the first time. **Manuel Roxas** (Jan 1, 1892 - Apr 15, 1948) is chosen Senate President; Elpidio Quirino (Nov 16, 1890 - Feb 28, 1956),

Senate President pro-tempore; Jose Julueta, Speaker of the House of Representatives; and Prospero Singson, Speaker pro-tempore of the House of Representatives.

- **1945, Jul 5.** General MacArthur announces the **liberation** of the Philippines.
- **1945, Aug 6.** The Americans drop an atomic bomb over **Hiroshima**, Japan.
- **1945, Aug 9.** The Americans drop an atomic bomb over **Nagasaki**, Japan.
- **1945, Aug 15.** Japan accepts defeat.
- **1945, Sep 12.** President Laurel is arrested by the US army and first confined in **Sugamo prison**, located in the outskirts of Tokyo; later he is sent back to the Philippines. Other collaborators are shipped to the Iwahig penal colony in Palawan for judgment.
- **1945, Dec. Manuel Roxas** separates from the Nacionalista Party of Sergio Osmena Sr and joins the Liberal Party.
- **1946, Apr 20.** The last presidential election under the **Commonwealth** is held; **Roxas** wins over Osmena by approximately 200,000 votes. Roxas' running mate, Elpidio Quirino, is elected Vice-President.
- 1965 - Ferdinand E. Marcos is elected by a big majority as president.
- 1972 - Martial Law was declared by President Marcos.
- 1981 - Marcos lifts Martial Law.
- 1983 - Opposition leader Benigno "Ninoy" Aquino returns from exile and is assassinated on arrival at Manila International Airport; Aquino's widow Corazon leads the "People Power" protest movement.
- 1986 - Marcos was declared winner in a presidential election beating Corazon Aquino amid charges of fraud; demonstrations erupt; Marcos flees to Hawaii; Aquino is declared president and forms a new government.
- 1992 - Endorsed by Aquino, her Secretary of Defense Gen. Fidel Ramos wins presidential election. U.S. Philippine congress rejects a new treaty with the U.S. and Subic Bay naval base and Clark Air Field returns to Philippine government, ending American military presence in the Philippines.
- 1996 - The government of Ramos agrees to greater autonomy for southern island of Mindanao. Moro National Liberation Front (MNLF) ends the guerrilla war with the government.
- 1997 - Asian financial crisis grips Asia and the Philippines escapes the crisis despite series of currency devaluations.
- 1998 - Former movie actor Joseph Estrada is elected president.
- 2000 - On charges of corruption, the lower house impeach Estrada.
- 2001 - Estrada was forced to step down due to public outrage over corruption allegations. Vice President Gloria Macapagal-Arroyo assumes the presidency.
- 2004 - Presidential election takes place. Arroyo's closest rival (a dear friend of Ex-President Estrada) is film actor Fernando Poe, Jr. Arroyo narrowly defeats Poe, taking 39.5% of the vote to Poe's 36.6%.
- 2005 - A taped conversation between President Arroyo & an election official surfaced during the 2004 elections implying she influenced the official election results. Calls for her resignation and demonstrations followed soon after. In September 2005, Congress voted down the filing of an impeachment against Arroyo.
- 2007 - Former President Joseph Estrada is convicted of plunder, the first ever in the history of the Philippines.
- 2010 - First automated national elections in the Philippines.

- 2010 - Benigno "Noy" Simeon Cojuangco Aquino III wins the Presidential elections and sworn in at Manila's Rizal Park on June 30, 2010.